

IMO MEPC/ES.2 Meeting Summary

23 October 2025



The 2nd Extraordinary session (i.e. held outside of the regular meeting session) of the Marine Environment Protection Committee (MEPC/ES.2) was held 14-17 October 2025 at the IMO Headquarters in London, supplemented by hybrid (remote) participation. LISCR participated in the following groups in addition to the plenary:

Group	Subject
Plenary	All
WG 1	Working Group on Reduction of GHG Emissions from Ships (on the work plan – after completion of the drafting group)
DG 1	Drafting Group on Amendments to Mandatory Instruments

The plenary is the main session of the Committee attended by all Member States, while the Working Group and Drafting Group are smaller groups established to discuss specific tasks in detail.

Overall

Due to disagreement among participating member States, the meeting was put on hold for one year. As a result, no conclusion was reached, including on the draft amendments to the MARPOL Convention that would introduce new GHG reduction measures.

The official record will state that the meeting was “adjourned for one year.” No record of the discussions will be formally released until the meeting reconvenes and is concluded.

Adoption of GHG Mid-Term measure

Following the first two days discussions, the drafting group completed the draft text of a totally revised MARPOL Annex VI, with particular focus on introducing the IMO Net-Zero Framework (GHG mid-term measure), consisting of:

- A GHG reduction target (grams of CO₂ equivalent per total unit of energy consumed by ship in the reporting year (gCO₂eq/MJ), taking into account upstream emissions from extraction, production and delivery of fuel in addition to downstream emissions, hence well-to-wake emissions);
- A financial penalty in cases where a ship fails to meet the target;
- Rewarding mechanism of the collected fund; and
- A contribution to the Administration cost for the GHG Reduction Registry, which will handle the day-to-day administration of the GHG reduction mechanism.

The amendments included other issues such as:

- Accessibility of data under the IMO Data Collection System (DCS),
- Clarification of entries and data reporting required by regulations 27 and 28
- The review of the short-term GHG reduction measure (CII etc), and
- The use of multiple engine operational profiles for a marine diesel engine

However, the question of how the collected funds would be used, and who would decide on their allocation, was left to be addressed in guidelines to be developed later.

The text prepared by the drafting group included two options regarding entry into force: whether to apply the explicit-acceptance procedure (where Parties to MARPOL Annex VI must actively notify IMO of their acceptance to reach the two-thirds majority and 50 per cent of world tonnage), or the tacit-acceptance procedure (where the amendments are deemed accepted automatically unless one-third of the Parties, or Parties representing 50 per cent of the tonnage, formally notify IMO of non-acceptance).

However, as the plenary was adjourned before the group's report was reviewed, this matter is expected to be taken up again at the reconvened extraordinary session of the MEPC.

Following text was inserted as part of the future IMO Net-Zero Framework (the IMO GHG mid-term measures) (to appear on the cover page of the MEPC resolution adopting the amendments), its reflection in the official record is subject to the continuation of the meeting 12 months later.

- "The IMO Net-Zero Framework is the only global mid-term measure for international shipping"; and
- "The IMO Net-Zero Framework, once it enters into force, is the only global maritime mid-term measure for international shipping, in the interest of avoiding a possible patchwork of duplicative State or regional measures."

The following clarification was agreed during the meeting and finalized by the drafting group, but could be re-opened at the re-convened MEPC/ES.2.

- To limit the scope of company audits under draft regulation 26 to CII requirements only, while introducing periodic verification of SEEMP Part II; and, under draft regulation 36, to allow the banking and inter-ship transfer of surplus GFI units within defined time-based validity, as set out in draft appendices XII and XIII.
- Reporting: To use "calendar year", not "reporting period";
- To clarify ships' reporting obligations under draft regulation 33 by adding a reference to appendix IX and replacing the specific mention of the IMO DCS with a generic reference to IMO guidelines, while retaining the examples "such as wind propulsion and solar power" in the definition of "Energy total". Following this decision, drafting removed explicit reference to wind propulsion and solar power as it is now part of fuel as per definition;
- To clarify cases involving transfer of the flag State or the ISM Company, end-of-life ships, account opening for new ships, and information to be maintained in the IMO GFI Registry; and
- To refer to 2023 IMO GHG Strategy in the cover page of the resolution adopting the amendments.

Work plan

Work plan (target milestone) for IMO Net-Zero Framework

Plenary held an initial exchange of views on the Secretariat's draft work plan to prepare for the entry into force of the IMO Net-Zero Framework, with several delegations submitting comments and proposals, but no decision was taken at that stage. All related documents were referred to the Working Group on Reduction of GHG Emissions for further refinement. Based on the Secretariat's base document, the Working Group developed a consolidated draft work plan. The plenary agreed on the plan, subject to the adoption of the amendments. As the meeting was adjourned before the approval of the official record, the adoption did not take place, and the agreement on the plan is therefore not reflected in the official record.

Establish a new Sub-Committee on the Reduction of GHG Emissions from Ships

MEPC/ES.2 considered proposals to establish a new Sub-Committee on Reduction of GHG Emissions from Ships, recalling that the Council had left the decision to MEPC. While many delegations supported the idea in principle, recognizing the growing workload and need for a structured approach, others sought further assessment of budgetary implications, meeting frequency, and participation arrangements. MEPC/ES.2 agreed in principle to the establishment of the Sub-Committee, requested the Secretariat to develop draft terms of reference and possible working arrangements for future consideration, and invited the Council to explore necessary budget provisions, noting that a final decision would be taken at a later session.

However, as the meeting was adjourned before the adoption of the report, it remains uncertain whether a future Council session will take up this matter.

Further information

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